

Carson Shaffer

Portage, IN | carson@carsonshaffer.me | (219) 548-1884

carsonshaffer.me | linkedin.com/in/c-shaffer

SUMMARY

Security operations analyst with SOC experience in alert triage, investigation, and incident response support across endpoint, email, and identity in a financial services environment. Holds GCIH, OSCP, and GDSA certifications and is pursuing a part-time Master's in Information Security Engineering at SANS Technology Institute alongside full-time employment.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM and EDR: SentinelOne, Microsoft Defender XDR

Cloud & Identity: Azure, Entra ID, Defender for Identity, Defender for Cloud Apps

Network & Forensics: Wireshark, Malcolm, Autopsy

Email Security: Mimecast, KnowBe4 PhishER

Scripting and Query: PowerShell, Bash, KQL

Methodology: MITRE ATT&CK, PICERL, Cyber Kill Chain

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Analyst – Centier Bank | Merrillville, IN

Jun 2024 – Aug 2026

- Triaged and investigated security alerts across endpoint, email, and Entra ID identity queues using SentinelOne, Microsoft Defender XDR, and Defender for Identity, performing host and log analysis on phishing, malware, account compromise, and insider activity.
- Responded across the full incident lifecycle: detection, investigation, containment, eradication, and recovery, taking action across endpoint, identity, and email systems. Disabled compromised accounts, revoked active sessions, isolated affected endpoints, and blocked IOCs to confirm containment and prevent recurrence.
- Tuned and administered detection rules and configurations in SentinelOne and Mimecast to improve alert fidelity, and analyzed and remediated phishing submissions using KnowBe4 PhishER.
- Built a PowerShell script to reconcile asset records across endpoint management, EDR, and asset register platforms, identifying hundreds of unaccounted-for assets and devices missing critical security controls.

Digital Security Consultant – Crowe LLP | Chicago, IL

Aug 2023 – May 2024

- Investigated merchant risk using OSINT and commercial intelligence databases, documenting findings in detailed investigative reports. Selected for the firm's highest-risk cases based on accuracy and consistency.
- Assessed client environments against NIST CSF, ISO 27001, and GLBA, producing gap analyses that informed remediation priorities.

PROJECTS

Blog (blog.carsonshaffer.me)

- Publish technical writeups for TryHackMe and Hack The Box challenges covering topics like network traffic analysis, incident response investigations, and penetration testing.

National Cyber League Competition (Experienced Bracket)

- Spring 2026 Team: Ranked 3rd of 341 teams
- Spring 2026 Individual: Ranked 14th of 466 competitors

CERTIFICATION

- GIAC Experienced Incident Handler (GX-IH)
- GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH)
- GIAC Defensible Security Architecture (GDSA)
- OffSec Certified Professional (OSCP)
- GIAC Experienced Cybersecurity Specialist (GX-CS)

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Information Security Engineering – SANS TECHNOLOGY INSTITUTE

2025 – 2028

Bachelor of Science, Computer & Information Technology – PURDUE UNIVERSITY

2019 – 2023